HAYS RANCHES

HEALTH AND SAFETY MANUAL

Hays Ranches LLC

Agricultural application

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Issued by Corporate Safety | Approved by the Chief Executive Officer

This manual is issued by and speaks only for Hays Ranches LLC.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER 1. POLICY STATEMENT AND SCOPE....4
CHAPTER 2. SAFETY ORGANIZATION AND RESPONSIBILITIES....6
CHAPTER 3. INJURY AND ILLNESS PREVENTION PROGRAM....8
CHAPTER 4. CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES....11
CHAPTER 5. ENFORCEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY....12
CHAPTER 6. STOP WORK AUTHORITY....17
CHAPTER 7. PRE-TASK PLANNING....19
CHAPTER 8. INCIDENT INVESTIGATION AND REPORTING....21
CHAPTER 9. RECORDKEEPING AND RECORDS ACCESS....23
CHAPTER 10. HAZARD COMMUNICATION....25
CHAPTER 11. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT....27
MODULE AG-03. AGRICULTURAL HEAT AND NIGHT WORK....29
CHAPTER 13. EMERGENCY ACTION AND FIRE PROTECTION....31
CHAPTER 14. FIRST AID AND MEDICAL SERVICES....33
CHAPTER 15. FIT FOR DUTY, DRUG AND ALCOHOL, AND FATIGUE....35
CHAPTER 16. HOUSEKEEPING AND WALKING-WORKING SURFACES....37
CHAPTER 17. MATERIAL HANDLING AND ERGONOMICS....39
CHAPTER 18. HAND AND POWER TOOLS....40
CHAPTER 19. LADDERS....42
CHAPTER 20. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION....43
CHAPTER 21. SHORT SERVICE EMPLOYEES....45
CHAPTER 22. SUBCONTRACTOR SAFETY MANAGEMENT....47
CHAPTER 23. TRAINING AND ORIENTATION....49
CHAPTER 24. RETURN TO WORK....51
CHAPTER 25. DRIVING AND FLEET SAFETY....52
APPENDIX A. ENTITY SKIN....54
ENTITY SKIN. APPENDIX A PACKAGE....54
APPENDIX B. VARIANT RECORD....56
AGRICULTURAL CHASSIS VARIANT. CHAPTER SWAP SHEET.....56AGRICULTURAL APPLICATION NOTES56

PART II. WORK MODULES 58
MODULE AG-01. TRACTORS AND AGRICULTURAL EQUIPMENT 59
MODULE AG-02. FIELD WORK AND SANITATION 61
EARTHMOVING AND HEAVY EQUIPMENT 63
MODULE VB-08. WELDING, CUTTING AND HOT WORK 65
MODULE IH-01. NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION 66
MODULE TR-01. DOT / FMCSA FLEET COMPLIANCE POINTER 67
MODULE TR-02. DUMP, TRANSFER AND WATER TRUCK OPERATIONS 68
MODULE TR-03. LOAD SECUREMENT AND HEAVY HAUL 70
HAZARDOUS MATERIALS, WASTE AND SPILL RESPONSE 71
MODULE SS-03. FORKLIFTS AND INDUSTRIAL TRUCKS 73

Hays Ranches LLC

CHAPTER 1. POLICY STATEMENT AND SCOPE

The signature block and entity variables are completed at issuance at assembly.

1.1 Safety Policy

It is the policy of Hays Ranches LLC that every person on our work goes home in the same condition they arrived. No schedule, no client demand, and no dollar amount changes that. Safe work is a condition of employment at every level of this company, and it is a condition of leadership: managers and supervisors are accountable for the safety of the people they direct.

The Company commits to the following:

- Provide the equipment, training, planning time, and staffing that safe work requires.
- Identify hazards before work begins and control them before anyone is exposed.
- Comply with every applicable safety and health regulation, and go beyond compliance where our work demands it.
- Investigate every incident and near miss to fix the system, and hold people accountable under one standard, consistently applied.
- Back every employee who stops work over a safety concern. Without exception.

Every employee commits to work by this manual, follow the 7 Rules That Keep You Alive, plan their work, look out for the person next to them, and stop work when something is wrong.

_____

Kirby Hays, Chief Executive Officer Date

1.2 Scope

This manual applies to every employee of Hays Ranches LLC, on every jobsite, facility, yard, and vehicle, on every shift. It applies to temporary employees and to any person working under the Company's direction. Subcontractors are governed by their own programs and by Chapter 22 where this entity acts as a controlling contractor.

This manual is issued by and speaks only for Hays Ranches LLC. It creates no obligations for, and makes no statements on behalf of, any other company.

1.3 Related Programs and Order of Precedence

This manual works alongside the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline), the Fleet Management Program, the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, the Workplace Violence Prevention Plan, and client site rules and contract safety exhibits. Where requirements differ between any of these documents, or between this manual and a regulation, the stricter requirement governs. Where a client rule is stricter than ours, we follow the client rule on that client's work. Where ours is stricter, ours applies everywhere.

Nothing in this manual creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment.

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CHAPTER 2. SAFETY ORGANIZATION AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Named persons for this entity are listed in Appendix A so personnel changes never require a manual revision.

2.1 How Responsibility Runs

Safety responsibility follows the chain of command. It is never delegated away: assigning a duty to someone does not remove it from the person above them. The named-person table for this entity, including the IIPP Administrator, is in Appendix A. Competent person designations by discipline are kept in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety; anyone who needs to know who is competent person trained for a task contacts Corporate Safety.

2.2 Responsibilities by Role

Chief Executive Officer

- Owns this policy. Signs it, funds it, and holds leadership accountable to it.
- Sits on the review committee for Step 3 and Step 4 discipline actions (Chapter 5.7).

Vice President

- Accountable for implementation across operations. Resolves resource conflicts in favor of safe work.
- Sits on the review committee. Reviews the central safety log and program metrics with Corporate Safety.

Corporate Safety Officer

- IIPP Administrator. Maintains this manual, the module library, the central safety log, and the training matrix.
- Reviews every discipline action above Step 1 before issuance. Leads or oversees every incident investigation (Form 10A).
- Conducts unannounced site and facility inspections and tracks corrective actions to closure.

Entity Operations Leadership

- Builds safety into schedules, budgets, and manning. A plan that cannot be executed safely is not an approved plan.
- Consulted on job impact before committee decisions are final (Chapter 5.7).

Superintendents and Foremen

- Own safety on their sites and crews. Lead pre-task planning, run tailboards, conduct inspections, enforce the rules on the spot, and document coaching in the central log.
- A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation (Chapter 5.8).

Site Safety Officers (where assigned)

- Support the superintendent with inspections, orientations, monitoring, and documentation. Assignment of an SSO does not transfer the superintendent's responsibility.

Fleet Manager

- Authority for vehicle and DOT matters under the Fleet Management Program. Chapter 25 governs the interface.

Every Employee

- Work by this manual and the 7 Rules. Inspect your equipment. Plan your task. Wear your PPE.
- Report hazards, injuries, near misses, and damage the same shift. Stop work that is not safe.

2.3 Competent Persons

Work that requires a competent person under Title 8 (excavation, scaffolds, fall protection, and others per the entity's modules) is not performed until a designated competent person is on site with the authority to stop the work and correct the hazard. Designations are made in writing by Corporate Safety based on training and demonstrated experience, and are tracked in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety. Anyone who needs to confirm a designation contacts Corporate Safety. Holding a card does not make a person competent; the designation does.

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CHAPTER 3. INJURY AND ILLNESS PREVENTION PROGRAM

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3203).

3.1 Purpose

This chapter is the Injury and Illness Prevention Program required by Title 8, California Code of Regulations, Section 3203. It is the framework every other chapter hangs on: who is responsible, how hazards get found and fixed, how we communicate about safety, how incidents get investigated, and how training happens. If a question is not answered elsewhere in this manual, it is answered here.

3.2 Responsibility

The IIPP Administrator for Hays Ranches LLC is the Corporate Safety Officer, Sergio Robles, with authority and responsibility for implementing and maintaining this program. Entity operations leadership, superintendents, and foremen implement it on every site, every shift. Every employee is responsible for working safely, following this manual, and reporting hazards. The named-person table for this entity, including the Administrator and designated competent persons, is in Appendix A.

3.3 Compliance

The system for ensuring employees comply with safe work practices is Chapter 5, Enforcement and Accountability: one standard, three tiers, four steps, applied identically to everyone. Compliance is also recognized: supervisors and Corporate Safety acknowledge crews and individuals who work safely, surface hazards, and stop work when conditions call for it. Safe work is a condition of employment.

3.4 Communication

Safety communication runs in both directions, in a form readily understandable by all affected employees, including Spanish where crews require it:

- Daily pre-task planning and tailboard meetings on every crew (Chapter 7).
- Toolbox talks at least weekly, documented with topic and attendance.
- Safety alerts issued by Corporate Safety after significant incidents, near misses, or regulatory changes.
- New-hire orientation and the condensed field handbook (Chapter 23).

- Direct access: any employee may raise any safety concern to any supervisor, Corporate Safety, or Human Resources, in any language, at any time.
- Anonymous reporting: employees may report hazards anonymously to Corporate Safety, by phone or through the posted safety QR code, which links to a report form that can be submitted anonymously and is delivered directly to Corporate Safety. No employee will be retaliated against for reporting a hazard or an injury, anonymously or by name (Chapter 5.3).

3.5 Hazard Identification and Periodic Inspections

Hazards are found on a schedule and whenever conditions change, not only after something goes wrong.

- Daily: the crew inspects the work area, tools, and equipment as part of pre-task planning. Equipment operators complete the daily equipment checklist before operation.
- Weekly: the superintendent or foreman conducts and documents a site inspection on the standard checklist.
- Monthly: yards, shops, and facilities are inspected on the facility checklist by the responsible manager.
- Periodic and unannounced: Corporate Safety inspects sites and facilities across the entity, prioritized by risk and incident history.
- Event-driven: inspections are performed whenever new substances, processes, equipment, or procedures are introduced, whenever a new or previously unrecognized hazard is reported, and after any incident or near miss.

Inspection records identify the site, the date, the inspector, the hazards found, and the correction status, and are retained per Chapter 9.

3.6 Incident Investigation

Every occupational injury, illness, near miss, and property or utility damage event is investigated under Chapter 8 on Form 10A. The investigation identifies what happened, why the system allowed it, and what will prevent it, and its corrective actions are tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.7 Hazard Correction

Hazards are corrected when found. Where correction takes time, interim protection is put in place immediately.

- Imminent hazard: work in the affected area stops now. Exposed employees are removed, and only employees necessary to correct the condition, with proper protection, may enter. Work does not resume until the hazard is corrected.
- Serious hazard: corrected before the affected work continues, and no later than the same shift.
- Other hazards: corrected on a documented schedule with a named owner, tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.8 Training and Instruction

Training is provided when the program is first established, to every new employee at orientation, to every employee given a new job assignment for which training has not been received, whenever new substances, processes, procedures, or equipment introduce a new hazard, whenever the Company is made aware of a new or previously unrecognized hazard, and to supervisors on the hazards of the work they direct. The role-based training matrix, refresher cadences, and verification requirements are in Chapter 23. Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time.

3.9 Records

IIPP records, including inspection records and training documentation, are maintained per Chapter 9. Inspection records are retained at least one year; training records at least three years, or longer where a specific standard requires it.

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CHAPTER 4. CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Posted at each jobsite, or readily available with a posted notice of its location, per T8 1509. It is entity-specific and speaks only in Hays Ranches LLC's name.

CHAPTER 5. ENFORCEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Entity manuals are generated from this master; do not edit entity copies directly.

5.1 Purpose and Principle

This chapter sets one standard for safety accountability. The same rules, the same tiers, and the same consequences apply to every employee of Hays Ranches LLC, from a first-day laborer to the most senior superintendent, in every division and on every jobsite. Discipline under this chapter is corrective before it is punitive: the goal is that everyone goes home, every day. The Company distinguishes honest mistakes from risky drift and from conscious disregard, and it responds to each differently. What it does not do is look the other way.

This chapter works together with the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline). Nothing in this chapter creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment. The Company retains discretion under Handbook Section 8.5 to apply the level of corrective action appropriate to the facts and circumstances of each case.

5.2 The 7 Rules That Keep You Alive

Seven rules cover the hazards most likely to kill or seriously injure. They are posted at every jobsite and facility, issued on a wallet card to every field employee, and signed for at orientation.

1. Tie off above 6 feet. Every time.

Ladders, scaffolds, lifts, and roofs included. Anchor points rated for 5,000 pounds.

2. Lock it. Tag it. Try it.

Verify zero energy and apply your own lock and tag before working on any energized system.

3. Know your line of fire.

Never under a suspended load, never in a swing radius, never between moving equipment and a fixed object.

4. No trench entry without protection.

Five feet or deeper requires a competent person inspection, protective systems, and egress within 25 feet.

5. Live track and live traffic kill.

No one fouls a track or steps into a traffic lane until on-track safety or traffic control is established and the briefing is complete.

6. Seatbelts on. Spotter when backing. Phone down.

Every vehicle, every piece of mobile equipment, every shift. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or where vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

7. Show up ready to work.

Free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Disclose any medication that affects alertness before your shift.

5.3 Stop Work Authority and Anti-Retaliation

Every employee has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe is unsafe. Work does not resume until the condition is corrected and the person who stopped the work, or a supervisor, confirms it is safe to proceed. No employee will ever be disciplined, demoted, reassigned, or treated worse for stopping work in good faith, reporting a hazard, reporting an injury, or refusing unsafe work. Retaliation against an employee who exercises stop work authority or reports in good faith is itself a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

5.4 The Three Violation Tiers

Tier	Definition	Examples	Entry Point
Tier 1. Life-Critical	Conduct that could kill or seriously injure. Violations of the 7 Rules.	Untied at heights; LOTO bypass; line-of-fire violation; unprotected trench entry; fouling live track or traffic without protection; removing or disabling a safety device; working impaired.	Enters at Step 3. Reckless conduct enters at Step 4.
Tier 2. Major Operational	Serious failure of judgment, process, or care that creates significant risk, cost, or exposure. The test: did this violation, by itself, create real risk, cost, or exposure to the company, the public, or the crew — regardless of whether anyone got hurt or anything actually broke? If yes, it's Tier 2.	Negligent equipment damage with skipped procedure; operating outside qualifications; refusing PPE after correction; concealing damage or an incident; supervisor failure to enforce; retaliation-adjacent conduct.	Enters at Step 2.
Tier 3. Process	The daily disciplines that	Missed PPE; missed JHA	Enters at Step 1.

Compliance	prevent everything else. The test: did this violation weaken a safeguard or process step without creating risk, cost, or exposure on its own — something that only matters if something else also goes wrong? If yes, it's Tier 3.	or pre-task plan; missed equipment checklist; missed toolbox attendance; housekeeping after a request.	

Falsification of any safety record, inspection, timecard, or qualification document is treated outside the ordinary ladder: a single proven instance is grounds for termination regardless of tier.

5.5 Behavior Classification (Just Culture)

The tier sets the entry point. Before any Step 3 or Step 4 action, the review committee classifies the behavior. Same act, different intent, different response.

Classification	Meaning	Response
Human Error	An honest mistake by someone trying to do the right thing, often set up by a system, training, or tool gap.	Console the person. Fix the system. No discipline.
At-Risk Behavior	Drift from the rule because the risk was not seen, was rationalized, or had become normal on the crew. The most common finding.	Coach, document, retrain. The tier entry point applies. Repeat preventable events escalate per the rules in 5.6.
Reckless Behavior	Knew the rule, knew the risk, chose to ignore it.	Escalation above the entry point. Reckless Tier 1 conduct is grounds for termination.
No-Fault / System Failure	No employee behavior contribution: procedures were followed and the system still produced the outcome.	No discipline of any kind. The system is examined and fixed; the event is logged for trend analysis.

The substitution test: would three other employees with the same training, at the same skill level, in the same conditions, likely have made the same choice? If yes, the problem is the system and the fix is the system. If no, the classification above governs.

For Tier 1 violations, the Company may impose any step up to and including termination based on the totality of the circumstances, including the potential for harm, the vulnerability of the public or the crew, client and site requirements, and the employee's overall record. The tiers

describe the ordinary response; they do not limit the Company's discretion under Handbook Section 8.5.

5.6 The Four-Step Ladder

Step	Action	Approval Required
Step 1. Documented Coaching	The supervisor reports the event to the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift. The Corporate Safety Officer conducts and documents the coaching conversation with the employee, and logs it in the central safety log within 48 hours. Not a formal write-up. Documented coaching is conducted by the Corporate Safety Officer only; no one else delivers it.	Corporate Safety Officer
Step 2. Written Warning	Formal written warning, signed by the employee, filed in the personnel file and the central log. Retraining assigned within 14 days is paid time.	Review Committee
Step 3. Stand-Down (1 to 3 days, unpaid for non-exempt employees)	Removal from work. Documented re-orientation with Corporate Safety before return. A subsequent violation within 12 months results in termination. For exempt employees, unpaid suspension is structured in full workweek increments or as accrued PTO use, per wage and hour law.	Review Committee
Step 4. Termination	Separation after investigation. Final pay and separation requirements per state law.	Review Committee, with HR execution

Prior record. An employee's record includes all documented discipline and preventable incidents, including those documented before this program's effective date. The Review Committee considers the full record on every recommendation of Step 2 or higher. At adoption of this revision, Corporate Safety and Human Resources enter existing documented discipline and preventable incidents from the prior 12 months into the central safety log as opening history.

Repeat events. A second preventable Tier 1 or Tier 2 event within 12 months enters the ladder one step above the tier entry point. A third preventable event within 12 months is referred to the Review Committee for a termination decision, regardless of tier. Event counts are tracked in the central safety log.

Introductory period. During an employee's first 90 days of employment, the progressive ladder does not bind the Company. Any Tier 1 or Tier 2 event classified as At-Risk or Reckless Behavior during the introductory period is routed directly to the Review Committee as an employment suitability decision, with termination available at entry. Events classified No-Fault / System Failure or Human Error, stopping work in good faith, and honest reporting are never grounds for action under this paragraph, during the introductory period or at any other time.

Active Steps 1 through 3 reset after 12 months of violation-free work, tracked in the central safety log. Time spent in required retraining is paid for all employees.

5.7 The Review Committee

One committee reviews every proposed Step 3 and Step 4 action, every introductory period routing and third-event referral under Section 5.6, and every driving event escalation under the Driver Acceptability Standards: the Chief Executive Officer, the Vice President, the Corporate Safety Officer, and the Human Resources Manager, or their written designees. Field operations leadership is consulted on job impact before decisions are final but is not a required approver. No Step 3 or Step 4 action is issued without committee review, and no supervisor may promise or impose one on their own. Corporate Safety reviews every action above Step 1 before it is issued to keep classification and consequences consistent across all divisions and entities.

5.8 Supervisors Are Accountable for Enforcement

A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation. Enforcement is not optional and it is not personal. Supervisors document coaching conversations, correct hazards on the spot, and escalate what they cannot correct. Leadership backs supervisors who hold the line.

5.9 Driving Events

Driving and vehicle events are governed by the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix and the Fleet Management Program. Where a driving event is also a violation of the 7 Rules (for example, seatbelt not worn, handheld phone in motion, or operating impaired), the safety tier sets the minimum response and the review committee resolves both tracks in a single decision. One event, one committee, one outcome.

5.10 Employees Covered by a Collective Bargaining Agreement

No employees of Hays Ranches LLC are currently covered by a collective bargaining agreement. This section is retained as the group framework and activates by skin reissue if that changes.

The safety rules in this manual, the 7 Rules, stop work authority, and the violation tiers apply identically to every employee, including employees covered by a collective bargaining agreement. For CBA-covered employees, the procedure for imposing discipline, including notice,

representation, and grievance rights, follows the applicable agreement. Nothing in any agreement limits the Company's authority to remove an employee from work immediately for a safety violation pending the contractual process. Where this chapter and a CBA procedure differ, the CBA procedure governs the process; the safety standard itself does not change.

Not applicable at issue.

5.11 The Central Safety Log

Every coaching, warning, stand-down, termination, incident, near miss, and stop work event is entered in the central safety log maintained by Corporate Safety within 48 hours. Corporate Safety keeps the log current. Monthly, Corporate Safety provides the log to the Review Committee with an analysis of trends and recommended actions to prevent what the log shows developing.

5.12 Equipment Damage

All damage to equipment, vehicles, tools, and property, whether owned, rented, client, or third party, is reported, investigated, and resolved under this section. The purpose is the same as the rest of this program: find and fix the system, hold knowing violations accountable, and never give anyone a reason to hide damage.

Reporting. All damage, however minor, is reported to the supervisor and the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift it occurs or is discovered (Chapter 8.1). A scratch reported is a repair; a scratch hidden is a falsification problem. Damaged equipment that could affect safe operation is taken out of service, tagged, and not returned until cleared. Damage involving a utility, the public, a client's property, or a regulator follows Chapter 8 in full.

Investigation. Damage events are investigated on Form 10A with a Form 10A-1 for each employee involved. The first question is always behavioral: were all applicable procedures followed? If yes, the event is No-Fault / System Failure: no discipline of any kind. The damage is logged, the system is examined, and corrective actions are assigned with named owners and due dates. If a procedure was not followed, the behavior is classified under this chapter: human error, at-risk behavior (coached by the Corporate Safety Officer, documented, retrained), or reckless conduct (tier assignment and the discipline ladder).

A violation of a 7 Rules requirement in a damage event (seatbelt, spotter, raised bed, lockout) is a Tier 1 matter regardless of the damage amount. Concealing damage, or falsifying an inspection, checklist, or record connected to it, is outside the ladder entirely: a single proven instance is a terminable offense, routed directly to the Review Committee.

Discipline keys to behavior, never to the repair bill. A $50,000 failure with every procedure followed is a No-Fault system event. A $200 mirror knocked off while backing without a spotter is a 7 Rules violation. Repair costs are recorded in the central safety log for trend analysis only.

The moment discipline follows dollars, small damage disappears underground and surfaces later as big damage.

Tracking. Every damage event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours with unit, description, estimated cost, classification, and corrective actions. Repeat events on the same unit, crew, or cause are flagged in the monthly Review Committee report with recommended prevention actions. Vehicle events that are also DOT matters follow the Fleet Management Program: one event, one investigation, one committee.

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CHAPTER 6. STOP WORK AUTHORITY

This chapter expands the standard set in Chapter 5.3 into the working procedure.

6.1 The Authority

Every employee of Hays Ranches LLC, regardless of position, seniority, or trade, has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe presents a danger to any person, the public, or a utility. The authority extends to stopping the work of other crews and, on our sites, the work of subcontractors. No permission is needed. No justification beyond a good-faith concern is required. A stop work call made in good faith is never wrong, even when the concern turns out to be unfounded.

6.2 How Work Gets Stopped

- Say it plainly: STOP WORK. Address the person in the hazard first, the supervisor second.
- Make the area safe. Remove people from exposure. Do not attempt to correct an imminent hazard alone or without protection.
- Notify the supervisor immediately. The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for any stop involving a life-critical hazard, a utility, the public, or a subcontractor.

6.3 Restart

Work resumes only when all three are true: the condition is corrected or controlled, the person who stopped the work or the supervisor confirms it is safe to proceed, and the crew is briefed on what changed. If the person who stopped the work and the supervisor disagree on whether it is safe to resume, the work stays stopped and the question goes to Corporate Safety. Corporate Safety's call is final.

6.4 Documentation

Every stop work event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours: who stopped it, what the condition was, how it was corrected, and when work resumed. Stop work events are reviewed for system lessons, never for blame. Crews and individuals who make good stop work calls are recognized for them.

6.5 No Retaliation

Chapter 5.3 applies in full. Retaliation against any person for stopping work or raising a concern in good faith is a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

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CHAPTER 7. PRE-TASK PLANNING

One form set is used group-wide; the forms are indexed in Appendix B.

7.1 The Daily Plan

The daily plan is executed on the daily tailboard record issued for this entity, completed and signed by every crew member each shift, with the task-level Job Safety Analysis redone whenever the task, the site, or conditions change.

No task starts without a plan. Every crew completes a written Job Hazard Analysis / Pre-Task Plan (JHA/PTP) at the start of every shift, for every task, on the standard form. The plan is written at the work location, by the crew that will do the work, led by the foreman or the most senior person on the task. It covers, at minimum:

- The steps of the task, in order.
- The hazards of each step, including utilities, energy sources, traffic, weather, adjacent crews, and the public.
- The controls for each hazard, named specifically: which protective system, which barrier, which permit, which PPE.
- Who is assigned to each role, including competent persons, spotters, and flaggers where the work requires them.
- The manual handling on the task: the heaviest and most repetitive lift, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates (Chapter 17).
- Emergency information: nearest medical facility, muster point, and who calls 911.

7.2 The Tailboard

The plan is worthless if the crew has not heard it. The foreman briefs the full crew on the plan before work begins. Every crew member signs the JHA/PTP. Anyone who joins the crew mid-shift is briefed and signs before starting work. Questions at the tailboard are a strength: a crew member who does not understand the plan says so, and the plan is explained or fixed.

7.3 Changed Conditions

The plan matches the work or the work stops. When conditions change (different task, different location, weather, an unexpected utility, new equipment, a new crew member, or anything the plan did not anticipate), work pauses and the plan is redone or amended before work continues. A plan written for the morning does not cover an afternoon that looks different.

7.4 Documentation and Quality

Completed JHA/PTP forms are retained per Chapter 9 and are reviewed by superintendents on their weekly inspections and by Corporate Safety on site visits. The standard is a real plan for the real work of that day. A pre-filled, copied, or generic form is not a plan; a form signed by people who were not briefed is falsification under Chapter 5.4, and both are treated accordingly.

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CHAPTER 8. INCIDENT INVESTIGATION AND REPORTING

Form 10A is the standard investigation record group-wide.

8.1 What Gets Reported, and When

Every employee reports the following to their supervisor immediately, and in no case later than the end of the shift in which it occurred. The supervisor reports to Corporate Safety the same shift.

- Any injury or illness, however minor. First aid cases included.
- Any near miss: an event that could have caused injury, damage, or a utility strike under slightly different circumstances.
- Any utility contact or damage, any equipment or property damage, and any vehicle event.
- Any fire, spill, or release.
- Any contact from a regulator, and any incident involving the public or a client's facilities.

Late reporting is a Tier 2 violation. Concealing an incident is treated at Step 3 minimum, and falsifying a report is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4. Reporting an incident honestly is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

8.2 Immediate Response and Scene Preservation

- People first: care for the injured, remove others from exposure, and call 911 where warranted. First aid and medical services per Chapter 14.
- Make the scene safe, then leave it alone. After a serious incident, nothing is moved, altered, or cleaned up except to rescue, prevent further harm, or as directed by responders, until Corporate Safety releases the scene.
- Photograph conditions as found. Identify witnesses and separate them for statements while memory is fresh.

8.3 External Reporting

Corporate Safety makes all regulatory notifications. In California, any serious injury or illness, or any death, is reported to Cal/OSHA immediately and in no case more than 8 hours after the Company knows or should have known of it (T8 CCR 342). Utility damage notifications, environmental releases, DOT-reportable events, and client notifications follow the applicable module and contract. No employee makes a regulatory or media statement about an incident; inquiries go to Corporate Safety and leadership.

8.4 The Investigation

Every reportable event under 8.1 is investigated on Form 10A. Corporate Safety leads or oversees the investigation; the supervisor of the affected work participates. Investigations begin within 24 hours and are completed promptly, with serious incidents given priority over all other safety work. The investigation establishes the facts, the sequence, the direct causes, and the system causes: what about our planning, training, equipment, supervision, or procedures allowed this to happen.

Behavior found in the investigation is classified under Chapter 5.5 before any discipline is proposed. The investigation answers what happened and why. The review committee answers what follows from it.

8.5 Corrective Actions

Every investigation produces corrective actions with a named owner and a due date, entered in the central safety log and tracked to closure. Corrective actions that change a rule, a procedure, or a module trigger an update to this manual under the version control process, and a safety alert to affected crews where warranted. Any module touched by an incident investigation is reviewed immediately.

8.6 Post-Incident Testing and Claims

Post-incident drug and alcohol testing is governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including its DOT riders. Testing decisions follow that policy's criteria, never assumption or accusation. Injury claims, medical management, and return to work are handled under Chapter 24 and the claims protocol; supervisors report claims information to Corporate Safety and HR only.

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CHAPTER 9. RECORDKEEPING AND RECORDS ACCESS

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 14300 series, 3204). 1020.

9.1 Principle

Records are how this program proves itself: to a regulator, to a carrier, to a court, and to ourselves. A record that does not exist, cannot be found, or was filled in after the fact is worse than no program at all. Every record required by this manual has an owner, a home, and a retention period. Falsification of any record is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4.

9.2 Injury and Illness Recordkeeping

- Corporate Safety maintains the OSHA 300 Log and 301 incident reports for Hays Ranches LLC. Recordable cases are entered within 7 calendar days of learning of them. Recordability decisions are made by Corporate Safety, never by a supervisor in the field.
- The 300A annual summary is certified by entity executive leadership and posted at each establishment from February 1 through April 30, and submitted electronically where size and industry thresholds require it.
- Logs and summaries are retained 5 years and updated when case status changes.
- Privacy cases are handled per the regulation: the name comes off the log, the case stays on it.

9.3 Program Records and Retention

Record	Owner	Retention
JHA/PTP forms, tailboards, toolbox talks	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Inspection records (site, facility, equipment)	Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Training and orientation records, acknowledgments, certifications	Corporate Safety training matrix	3 years minimum, and for the duration of the certification
Incident investigations (Form 10A) and corrective actions	Corporate Safety, central safety log	5 years
Discipline records under Chapter 5	HR personnel file and central safety log	Per HR retention schedule
Employee exposure and medical records	HR / Corporate Safety, confidential	Duration of employment plus 30 years (T8 3204)
Permits (confined space, hot work, excavation, client permits)	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year, or per the governing standard

9.4 Employee Access

Any employee, former employee, or their designated representative may request their own exposure and medical records under T8 3204 and the injury log entries the regulation entitles them to see. Requests go to Corporate Safety or HR and are fulfilled within the regulatory timelines. Medical records are confidential and are released only as the regulation and the employee's authorization allow.

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CHAPTER 10. HAZARD COMMUNICATION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 5194). 1200.

10.1 Purpose and Scope

Employees have the right to know what chemicals they work with and around, what those chemicals can do to them, and how to protect themselves. This program covers every hazardous chemical used or stored by Hays Ranches LLC: fuels, oils, solvents, adhesives, concrete and masonry products, compressed gases, paints and coatings, and shop chemicals. It applies on our sites, in our yards and shops, and in our vehicles.

10.2 Chemical Inventory and Safety Data Sheets

- Corporate Safety maintains the master chemical inventory for the entity. Superintendents and yard managers keep their location list current; no new chemical is brought into use until its SDS is on file and any needed controls are in place.
- An SDS for every chemical at a location is accessible to every employee on that location during every shift, without asking permission: in the site or shop SDS binder, or electronically where reliable access exists, with a backup when it does not.
- If an SDS is missing, the chemical is not used until it is obtained.

10.3 Labels

- Manufacturer containers keep their labels, legible and intact. A container with a damaged or missing label is taken out of service until relabeled.
- A compliant label includes six elements: product identifier, signal word (Danger or Warning), hazard statement(s), pictogram(s), precautionary statement(s), and the supplier's name, address, and phone number. A label missing any of these is treated the same as a damaged or missing label under this section.
- Secondary containers (spray bottles, fuel cans, small mix containers) are labeled with the product identity and hazard warnings. The only exception is a container used immediately and completely by the person who filled it, within the shift.
- Fuel and chemical transfer containers meet the applicable container standards. Food and drink containers are never used for chemicals. Ever.

10.4 Training

Every employee is trained at orientation and whenever a new hazard is introduced: how to read a label and an SDS, the physical and health hazards of the chemical categories in their work —

including simple asphyxiants and combustible dust where present, such as confined space atmospheres and silica-generating work — how to detect a release, the protective measures and PPE required, and where the inventory and SDS collection live. Training is in a language and manner the employee understands, and is documented per Chapter 9.

10.5 Non-Routine Tasks and Multi-Employer Sites

- Before a non-routine task involving chemicals (tank or equipment cleaning, demolition of coated or treated materials, unexpected containers found in an excavation), the supervisor and Corporate Safety review the hazards and controls at the pre-task plan. Unknown containers or suspect materials stop the work until identified.
- On multi-employer sites, we inform other employers of the hazardous chemicals our work exposes their people to, provide SDS access, and obtain the same from them. Their chemical hazards go into our crew's pre-task plan.
- On client-controlled sites, the client's hazard communication program applies alongside this chapter; the stricter provision governs.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: SDS accessible without delay, labels intact on primary and secondary containers, non-routine task hazards reviewed before work starts, and training documented per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 11. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

The entity PPE table and any FR/arc-rated requirements are set out in Appendix A and work modules.

11.1 Principle

PPE is the last line of defense, never the first. Hazards are eliminated, substituted, engineered out, or controlled by procedure before PPE is relied on. But the last line holds: where PPE is required, wearing it correctly is a condition of being on the work, and a missed-PPE violation enters the discipline ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

11.2 Hazard Assessment

Corporate Safety certifies a written PPE hazard assessment for the entity's operations, by work type, reviewed annually and whenever the work changes. The assessment drives the entity PPE table in the skin. The daily JHA/PTP is the task-level assessment: it names the PPE for that day's work, including anything above the standard set.

11.3 Minimum Field Standard

On every jobsite and in every yard and shop work area, unless Appendix A or a work module sets more:

- Hard hat, ANSI Z89.1.
- Safety glasses, ANSI Z87.1. Face shield over them for cutting, grinding, chipping, and chemical splash.
- High-visibility apparel, Class 2 minimum; Class 3 for night work and where the traffic control module requires it.
- Safety-toe boots in serviceable condition, ASTM F2413.
- Gloves matched to the task: cut-rated for handling, chemical-rated for chemicals, leather for general work.
- Hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment. Respiratory, fall, FR, and arc-rated equipment per the applicable work module and the entity table.

11.4 Provision, Fit, and Care

- The Company provides required PPE at no cost to employees, in the sizes its people need. Prescription-compatible eye protection is accommodated.

- PPE is inspected by the wearer before each use. Damaged, expired, or contaminated PPE is removed from service and replaced; there is no discipline for asking for replacement gear, only for working without it.
- Fall protection, respirators, and other life-critical PPE are inspected, fitted, and maintained per their governing modules, including fit testing and medical evaluation where required.

11.5 Enforcement

Supervisors verify PPE at the tailboard and throughout the shift. Visitors and subcontractor personnel on our sites meet the same minimums or leave the work area.

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MODULE AG-03. AGRICULTURAL HEAT AND NIGHT WORK

Replaces Chapter 12 in the Hays Ranches manual. Carries the full T8 3395 program plus the agricultural high-heat additions and outdoor night work provisions.

1. The Base Program

Every element of the Company heat illness prevention program applies to ranch work: water at one quart per hour, fresh and suitably cool, as close as practicable; shade up and available for all employees on breaks when the temperature exceeds 80 degrees and on request below it; paid preventative cool-down rest of no less than 5 minutes whenever an employee needs it, with monitoring until symptoms pass; close observation of new workers for their first 14 days of hot work and of everyone during a heat wave; and the emergency response standard: heat stroke signs are a 911 call, aggressive cooling starts immediately, and no sick employee is ever left alone or sent off unaccompanied.

2. Agricultural High-Heat Procedures (95 Degrees and Above)

- Pre-shift meeting on the high-heat plan, water, symptoms, and the buddy system.
- Effective observation of every employee all shift: buddy system, supervisor observation of 20 or fewer, or regular contact with anyone working alone.
- Mandatory preventative cool-down rest periods for agricultural employees: at least 10 minutes every 2 hours, in shade, counted as paid time. During shifts longer than 8 hours, the additional rest periods continue on the same cycle. These are not optional and not combined away; the supervisor runs them on a clock.
- Reminders to drink throughout the shift, and pace and task rotation adjusted to the day.

3. Night Work

Night agricultural operations (harvest, irrigation, equipment moves) are planned, not improvised:

- Lighting for outdoor agricultural night work meets the applicable Title 8 requirements: work areas, equipment operating zones, and paths between them illuminated to the standard for the task, checked before the shift, with lighting placed to control glare for operators and drivers.
- Every night worker wears Class 2 high-visibility apparel around operating equipment and vehicles.
- The pre-shift meeting covers the lighting plan, the equipment/foot-crew interface, and the emergency plan adjusted for darkness: responder directions, lit meeting point, and a charged means of communication verified before work starts.

- Fatigue on night shifts is managed under Chapter 15: watch your crew, rotate tasks, and honor self-declarations.

4. Training

Every ranch employee and supervisor is trained on this module before hot work and before first night assignment, in a language the employee understands, documented per Chapter 9. Supervisors are additionally trained on the high-heat clock, observation duties, and emergency response, and are accountable for running them without being asked.

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CHAPTER 13. EMERGENCY ACTION AND FIRE PROTECTION

Facility-specific plans and maps are set out in Appendix A.

13.1 Scope

This chapter covers emergencies at fixed facilities (offices, yards, shops) and on jobsites: fire, medical emergency, severe weather, earthquake, utility emergencies, and any event requiring evacuation. Site-specific emergency information for field work lives in the daily pre-task plan (Chapter 7); this chapter sets the standard that plan must meet.

13.2 Emergency Action Plan

- Every facility has a posted evacuation map, designated exit routes kept clear at all times, a muster point, and a way to account for everyone on the property, including visitors.
- Every jobsite tailboard establishes the same three things daily: how the alarm is raised, where people go, and who accounts for the crew and calls 911.
- Alarm and notification: any employee who discovers an emergency raises the alarm first by the fastest means, then acts. On multi-employer sites, our alarm reaches the other employers' crews and theirs reaches ours; the controlling contractor's system governs.
- After any evacuation, nobody re-enters until the incident commander or responding agency clears it. Headcount discrepancies are reported to responders immediately; employees do not re-enter to search.
- Corporate Safety designates a person by name and title responsible for maintaining this chapter's plan and answering employee questions about it, and a person by name and title at each facility responsible for maintaining equipment that controls ignition sources and fuel hazards (fueling stations, heat-producing equipment, flammable storage). Both are named in the facility's Appendix A package.

13.3 Utility Emergencies

A struck gas line, downed or damaged electrical line, or damaged pressurized main is treated as a life threat, not a repair problem. Evacuate upwind and uphill for gas, establish distance for electrical (assume energized, minimum 30 feet, more for high voltage), eliminate ignition sources, call 911 and the utility owner, and keep the public back. The crew protects people and the perimeter; the utility owner makes it safe. Detailed procedures are in the underground utilities and electrical work modules.

13.4 Severe Weather and Earthquake

- Lightning within 10 miles (flash-to-bang 30 seconds or less) suspends exposed elevated work, crane operations, and open-field work until 30 minutes after the last strike.
- High wind suspends crane, hoisting, and panel operations per the equipment manual and the lift plan. Rain that defeats excavation protection or traffic control visibility suspends that work under the governing module.
- Earthquake: drop, cover, hold on inside; in the open, move clear of structures, poles, and lines. After shaking stops, evacuate per the plan, account for everyone, and treat every utility as suspect until inspected.

13.5 Fire Prevention and Protection

- Fuels, flammables, and compressed gases are stored, separated, and secured per the applicable standards; ignition sources are controlled around them, and refueling is done engine-off with bonding where required.
- Hot work (welding, cutting, grinding near combustibles) is performed under the hot work module with a fire watch where required.
- Portable extinguishers are provided at facilities, on jobsites, in company vehicles per the fleet standard, and on equipment where the module requires them: mounted, charged, accessible, visually checked monthly, and serviced annually.
- Extinguishers are distributed so travel distance never exceeds 75 feet for Class A hazards (ordinary combustibles) or 50 feet for Class B hazards (flammable liquids); Class C areas follow whichever of those patterns fits the underlying A or B hazard. Extinguisher type is matched to the hazard present — a Class B-rated unit alone is not sufficient where ordinary combustibles are also present.
- Employees are trained at orientation on extinguisher use and its limit: small, contained, early-stage fires only, with an exit at your back. Anything more is an evacuation and a 911 call. Fighting the fire is never required.
- Oily rags, packaging, sawdust, and other combustible waste are collected in covered metal containers and removed from the work area at the end of each shift; accumulation is not allowed to build up around ignition sources, exits, or extinguisher locations.

13.6 Drills and Review

Facilities conduct an evacuation drill at least annually, documented with date and attendance. The plan is reviewed after every drill, every real activation, and any facility change, and the lessons go into the master via the version control process. Every employee is trained on this chapter's plan before their first assignment, and retrained whenever their role changes in a way that affects their emergency duties or the plan itself changes. This is separate from and in addition to the annual evacuation drill.

CHAPTER 14. FIRST AID AND MEDICAL SERVICES

Designated clinics and facility postings are set out in Appendix A.

14.1 Trained Personnel

Every crew and every facility has ready access to a person currently certified in first aid and CPR. For field crews, that person is on the crew: certifications are tracked in the training matrix, planned into crew assignments by dispatch and the superintendent, and verified at pre-mobilization. Remote and right-of-way work is staffed so that trained response does not depend on outside help arriving quickly.

14.2 Supplies

- First aid kits sized to the crew are on every jobsite, in every crew truck per the fleet standard, and at every facility: inspected and restocked monthly and after every use, protected from dust and moisture, and matched to the hazards of the work per the modules (burn care, eye wash, trauma dressings where the work warrants).
- Where employees may be exposed to injurious corrosive materials, plumbed or portable eyewash meeting the standard is available at the work area, inspected on schedule.
- AEDs installed at facilities are inspected monthly and their locations posted.

14.3 Getting Help

- Every pre-task plan and every facility posting identifies: emergency numbers, the address or coordinates of the work, driving directions for responders, and the nearest emergency room and designated occupational clinic.
- Life threat, altered consciousness, uncontrolled bleeding, suspected spine injury, chest pain, heat stroke: call 911. Do not drive the person. For injuries below that line, a supervisor arranges transport to the designated clinic; an injured employee does not drive themselves.
- The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for every injury, however minor, per Chapter 8. First aid cases are logged even when no treatment beyond the kit is needed.

14.4 Bloodborne Pathogens

Employees designated as first aid responders and employees whose duties include cleanup of blood or bodily fluids are covered by the entity's bloodborne pathogens exposure control program: universal precautions, gloves and barriers in every kit, proper cleanup and disposal, hepatitis B vaccination offered per the standard, and immediate reporting and medical follow-

up for any exposure incident. Nobody cleans up blood bare-handed, and no exposure goes unreported.

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CHAPTER 15. FIT FOR DUTY, DRUG AND ALCOHOL, AND FATIGUE

The Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy is the single source of truth for all testing; this chapter does not duplicate it.

15.1 Fit for Duty

Rule 7 of the 7 Rules: show up ready to work, free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Fitness for duty is a condition of every shift, and it covers prescription and over-the-counter medication: any employee taking a medication that can affect alertness, judgment, coordination, or reaction time discloses it to their supervisor before the shift. The conversation is about the effect, never the diagnosis; medical information stays confidential with HR. Work assignments are adjusted while the effect lasts, and disclosure is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

15.2 Drug and Alcohol Policy

All drug and alcohol requirements, prohibitions, and testing (pre-employment, reasonable suspicion, post-incident, random, and return-to-duty, including DOT programs under 49 CFR Part 382 and any FRA or PHMSA riders that apply to the entity's work) are governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy. That policy is the single source of truth. Where this manual and that policy touch the same subject, that policy governs the testing process and this manual governs the safety consequence: working impaired is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5, and refusal to test is treated as the policy provides.

Supervisors are trained to recognize the signs of impairment and to act on them: an employee reasonably suspected of impairment is removed from work immediately, not sent to their vehicle and not left operating anything, and the reasonable suspicion process in the policy is followed the same shift.

15.3 Fatigue

Fatigue impairs like alcohol does, and it is managed like the hazard it is:

- Scheduling: work hours, night work, and consecutive days are planned with fatigue in mind. Hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers per the Fleet Management Program; extended shifts elsewhere get supervisor attention, not autopilot approval.
- Self-declaration: an employee too fatigued to work safely says so to their supervisor, before the shift or during it. A good-faith fatigue declaration is never disciplined; the response is an

assignment adjustment, rest, or a safe way home. Nobody drives home dangerously tired because they were afraid to say it.

- Night work: lighting, task rotation, and check-ins per the applicable module. Supervisors watch their crews for fatigue the same way they watch for heat illness.

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CHAPTER 16. HOUSEKEEPING AND WALKING-WORKING SURFACES

Slips, trips, and struck-by events are among this group's most frequent injuries; this chapter is a working control set, not a slogan.

16.1 The Standard

A clean site is a safe site, and it is also the public face of the Company. Housekeeping is part of the work, built into every task, every crew, every day. Clean as you go: debris, scrap, and packaging are removed as they are generated, not at the end of the week. The last hour of demobilization includes leaving the area clean.

16.2 Access and Walking Surfaces

- Walkways, stairs, ramps, and access routes are kept clear of materials, cords, hoses, tools, and mud buildup. A blocked exit route is corrected now, not noted for later.
- Cords and hoses crossing walkways are elevated, ramped, or routed around; crossing traffic areas, they are protected. Ground conditions (mud, ice, standing water, uneven backfill) are corrected, covered, or barricaded and lit.
- Holes and floor openings are covered per the fall protection module: secured, marked, and rated for the load, never a loose sheet of plywood.
- Work areas, stairs, and access routes have adequate lighting for the shift being worked; night work lighting per the applicable module.

16.3 Materials and Struck-By

- Materials are staged stable, stacked per manufacturer limits, banded or blocked against shifting, clear of edges, openings, and traffic lanes, and never within the buffer of a traffic control zone or the influence line of an excavation.
- Nails and screws in stripped lumber are pulled or bent flat before stacking. Rebar and other impalement hazards are capped or covered where any person could fall onto them.
- Tools and materials are secured against falling when work occurs overhead; barricades and toe boards protect the level below, and hard hat areas are enforced under it.

16.4 Responsibility

The foreman owns the housekeeping of the work area, the superintendent owns the site, and the yard or shop manager owns the facility. Housekeeping is checked on every weekly

inspection, and a housekeeping deficiency left standing after a request enters the ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

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CHAPTER 17. MATERIAL HANDLING AND ERGONOMICS

Repetitive trauma and manual handling injuries are a leading claims driver for this group. The Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program governs in full; this chapter states the field rules.

17.1 The Program

The Company maintains a written Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program, effective October 15, 2026, covering every Hays Group entity. It sets management responsibility, worker involvement, worksite evaluation, controls, training, early reporting and medical management, records, and annual review, and it satisfies Title 8, Section 5110 for California work. Corporate Safety owns it. Where this chapter and the Program differ, the Program governs. Rigging and hoisting are governed by the Cranes and Rigging module; this chapter and the Program cover what people move by hand and the postures, repetition, and vibration of the work.

17.2 Mechanical Aids First

The first question on any lift is not how to lift it. It is whether a person should be lifting it at all. Excavator rigging, pipe slings and clamps, vault lid and trench plate lifters, pipe carts and rollers, hand trucks, dollies, hose carts and balancers, cable pullers, cone and drum racks, hoists, and jacks exist so that backs do not do machine work. Planning a task includes planning how material moves: to the work, at the work, and away from it. The Program lists the standard aids for each operation. Crews use what is available to them, the foreman records the aid or method on the JHA/PTP, and where the preferred aid is not on site the foreman selects another method under the Program's lifting guidelines and records it. Corporate Safety inventories equipment by crew and the Review Committee fills gaps on a phased plan.

17.3 Manual Lifting

- **Limits.** One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions, and less when the load is awkward, far from the body, lifted from the floor or above the shoulders, or lifted repeatedly. Fifty to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical. Over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Pipe, vault lids, trench plates, shoring components, tires, and batteries above these limits are never lifted by hand. The limits are maximums, not targets.
- Size it up before you touch it: weight, path, footing, and where it lands. If the path is blocked, clear it first.
- Lift with the load close, back straight, legs driving, no twisting; turn with the feet. Set it down the same way.

- Team lift anything awkward, long, or heavier than one person handles comfortably, with one person calling the lift. Asking for a second set of hands is expected, never a knock.
- Where the site and delivery allow, materials are staged at working height, knee to shoulder, close to the point of use, so they are not lifted from the ground, carried over distance, or handled twice.
- Gloves matched to the material, and pinch points identified before the load moves: hands out of the crush zone when setting materials down.

17.4 Repetitive Trauma Prevention

- **Stretch and flex.** Crews do the five-minute routine in the Program as part of the morning tailboard, led by the foreman. A second round after lunch is recommended on heavy or repetitive work days.
- Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks across the crew where the work and crew size allow: shoveling, hose handling, flagging, trowel and vibrator work, cone placement, repetitive hand tool work. Breaks and task variety are planning items, not favors.
- Set up work at the right height where possible: stands, benches, and staging reduce sustained stooping and overhead reaching. Long-handled and extension tools, ratcheting and powered tools, and kneeling pads are the standard for the tasks the Program names.
- Operators and drivers adjust suspension seats and mirrors to themselves, use three points of contact, and take scheduled breaks out of the cab on long shifts. Worn seats are replaced through the fleet maintenance system.
- Employees new to a physically demanding task, or returning from time off or restricted duty, are paired with an experienced employee and eased into the work for the first days.

17.5 Planning and Worker Involvement

- The JHA/PTP (Form 4-B) and the Daily Safety Tailboard (Form 4-A) carry an ergonomics line: the heaviest and most repetitive handling on the task, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. It is completed with the crew, not for them.
- Any crew member may stop a lift or a task under Chapter 6 and ask for a different method or an aid. Discomfort or doubt is reason enough.
- Crew suggestions, discomfort reports, and evaluation findings go in the central safety log and into Corporate Safety's monthly report to the Review Committee (Chapter 5). Corporate Safety reports back to the crew on what was decided.

17.6 Worksite Evaluation

Corporate Safety, or a superintendent trained by Corporate Safety, evaluates a task for ergonomic risk using the Program checklist when a new task, tool, or operation starts; after any recordable or lost-time sprain, strain, or cumulative trauma injury, as part of the Form 10A investigation; after a discomfort report that meets the Program's criteria; when two or more employees in identical work have physician-diagnosed repetitive motion injuries within twelve months; and annually by operation during site inspections. The employees doing the task are

consulted and their input is recorded. Corrective actions are tracked to closure like any inspection finding.

17.7 Early Reporting

- Early reporting is the control that works. Aches, pain, numbness, tingling, swelling, stiffness, or loss of grip connected to work are reported to the supervisor the same day they are noticed, not when they become a claim. A discomfort report is not an injury claim.
- The supervisor records it on the Program's Discomfort Report, adjusts the task or rotates the employee that day, and sends the form to Corporate Safety and Human Resources before the end of the shift. Corporate Safety reviews it; a full evaluation follows under the criteria in the Program.
- Where symptoms persist or the employee requests it, evaluation at the designated clinic follows Chapter 14, and the event becomes an injury report under Chapter 8. Restrictions are managed under Chapter 24 with regular wages continued on transitional duty.
- Reporting a symptom is never disciplined. Discouraging, delaying, or talking an employee out of a report is a Chapter 5 violation. Supervisors do not diagnose and do not tell anyone to work through pain.

17.8 Training and Records

- Ergonomics is part of orientation under Chapter 23, with an annual refresher delivered through the existing safety meeting and tailboard schedule, task-specific training on assignment to new physical demands, and supervisor training on planning controls, leading stretch and flex, and taking a discomfort report. Delivered in English and Spanish and recorded in the training matrix with a signed acknowledgment.
- Evaluations, discomfort reports, training records, and the annual Program review are kept per Chapter 9 and the Program. Corporate Safety reviews the Program with executive leadership annually and after any cumulative trauma claim.

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CHAPTER 18. HAND AND POWER TOOLS

Powder-actuated tools, powered saws, and specialty equipment carry additional requirements in the applicable work modules.

18.1 The Right Tool, In Good Condition

Injuries with tools come from three places: the wrong tool, a damaged tool, or a defeated guard. All three are within the user's control, and all three are checked before use, every use. Cheater bars, modified tools, and homemade handles are not used. A tool used outside its design (a wrench as a hammer, a screwdriver as a chisel) is the wrong tool.

18.2 Inspection and Removal from Service

- The user inspects before each use: cords and plugs, guards, handles, bits and blades, hoses and fittings. Company tools get a documented periodic inspection per the shop program.
- A damaged or defective tool comes out of service now: tagged DO NOT USE and turned in for repair or destruction. Using a tool with a known defect is treated under Chapter 5 the same as any known-defect operation: Step 3 minimum.

18.3 Guards and Safety Devices

Guards stay on and functional. Removing, pinning, blocking, or otherwise defeating a guard, a trigger safety, or an interlock is removing a safety device: a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.4. A tool whose guard must come off for the task is the wrong tool for the task, and the work stops until the right one is on site.

18.4 Power and Environment

- Electric tools run on GFCI protection on construction sites, with cords rated for the service, protected from damage and water, and never carried or lowered by the cord.
- Pneumatic fittings are secured against disconnection (pins or clips plus whip checks on large lines); air is never used to clean clothing or skin.
- Fuel-powered tools are shut off to refuel and are not run in enclosed spaces without ventilation per the applicable module.
- Cutting, grinding, and chipping require the face shield over safety glasses per Chapter 11, hearing protection, and fire watch conditions per Chapter 13 where sparks reach combustibles.

CHAPTER 19. LADDERS

Fall protection above ladder work, scaffolds, and aerial lifts are governed by their own modules.

19.1 Is a Ladder the Right Answer

The first ladder decision is whether to use one at all. For work of any duration, at height, or requiring two hands and force, a scissor lift, boom lift, scaffold, or platform is usually the better and required answer. A ladder is for access and short-duration light work. If you cannot keep three points of contact and stay centered while doing the task, the task does not belong on a ladder.

19.2 Selection

- Duty rating matched to the user plus tools; Type IA or IAA for construction use.
  - Type IA ladders are rated for 300 lbs; Type IAA for 375 lbs. Verify the duty rating label matches the rated load before use, not just the ladder's general condition.
  - Maximum lengths: step ladder, 20 feet; two-section extension (wood), 60 feet; two-section extension (metal), 48 feet; three-section extension (metal), 60 feet; two-section extension (reinforced plastic), 72 feet. A ladder exceeding these lengths for its type is not used regardless of condition or rating.
  - Where 25 or more employees use a ladder at one location, or where two-way ladder traffic is expected, a double-cleat ladder is used, capped at 24 feet.
  - Ladders are never painted or coated with any opaque covering; a coating can hide cracks, splits, or corrosion. Identification or warning labels may be placed on one face of a side rail only.
- Fiberglass, and only fiberglass, anywhere near electrical work or where contact with any conductor is possible. Metal ladders are prohibited in those areas.
- The right length: an extension ladder extends at least 3 feet above the landing and is tied off or secured; a stepladder tall enough that the top two steps are never used, opened fully with spreaders locked, never leaned folded.

19.3 Setup and Use

- Inspected by a qualified person before each use: rails, rungs, feet, spreaders, ropes, and labels. A damaged ladder is tagged "Dangerous, Do Not Use," removed from service immediately, and destroyed or repaired by qualified means, never left where someone can grab it.

- On a two-section extension ladder, the sections overlap by at least: 3 feet for ladders up to 36 feet; 4 feet for ladders over 36 feet up to 48 feet; 5 feet for ladders over 48 feet up to 60 feet. A ladder without adequate overlap for its extended length is not used.
- Set on a firm, level base, feet secured against ice and mud, at 4 to 1 for extension ladders, in a cleared and, where exposed, barricaded area; doors it could be struck through are locked or guarded.
- Three points of contact, facing the ladder, belt buckle inside the rails. Tools go up on a hoist line or in a belt, never carried in the climbing hand.
- One person on a ladder at a time unless it is designed for two. Fall protection applies above the thresholds in the fall protection module, including on fixed ladders per that module.

19.4 Training and Verification

- Every employee who uses a ladder is trained before first use on: selecting the right ladder for the task (length or height needed, working load, duty rating, and how often it's used); erecting a ladder correctly (footing support, top support, securing, and angle of inclination); climbing and working position and points of contact; the factors that contribute to falls (haste, sudden movement, lack of attention, footwear, and physical condition); and prohibited uses (using a ladder for anything other than its designed purpose, climbing the cross-bracing, exceeding maximum lengths, and insufficient overlap on extension sections).
- Supervisors of employees who routinely use ladders receive this same training, not just the employees using the ladders.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: correct ladder selected for the task, duty rating and length within limits, inspection current, setup angle and securing correct, and training on file for the crew present.

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CHAPTER 20. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION

This chapter summarizes the entity's standalone Workplace Violence Prevention Plan under California Labor Code 6401.9; the WVPP document governs in full.

20.1 Policy

Hays Ranches LLC does not tolerate violence, threats, intimidation, or harassment on its worksites, in its facilities, or in its vehicles, whether from employees, subcontractors, clients, or the public. This applies to conduct in person, by phone, and online where it reaches the workplace. Weapons are prohibited on Company property and worksites except as the law requires the Company to allow.

20.2 What Gets Reported

Employees report every incident, threat, or credible concern to their supervisor, Corporate Safety, or HR, including the four types the law recognizes: violence by an outsider with criminal intent, by a client or member of the public, by a current or former employee, and by someone with a personal relationship to an employee. Public interaction is real exposure for our crews on roadways and rights-of-way: aggressive drivers, confrontations at closures, and threats at work areas are workplace violence incidents and are reported and logged the same as anything internal. Reports can be made without fear of retaliation, and no employee is disciplined for reporting in good faith or for leaving a situation they reasonably believed was dangerous.

20.3 Response and the Violent Incident Log

- Immediate danger: get to safety, call 911, then notify the supervisor. Nobody is expected to confront an aggressor over property or a traffic device.
- Every incident is investigated under the WVPP, and every workplace violence incident is entered in the violent incident log with the detail the statute requires, retained 5 years. Corrective actions (site changes, staffing, client escalation, law enforcement referral) are tracked to closure.
- Employee conduct found to violate this chapter is handled under Chapter 5 and the Employee Handbook; threats and violence enter the ladder at the top.

20.4 Training

Every employee is trained on the WVPP at orientation and annually: the plan, how to report, the hazards specific to their work including public interaction at traffic control and right-of-way locations, and how to respond. Training records per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 21. SHORT SERVICE EMPLOYEES

Client SSE programs (ISNetworld and contract exhibits) may set stricter ratios; the stricter rule governs per Chapter 1.

21.1 Who Is an SSE

A Short Service Employee is anyone with less than 6 months of service with the Company, and anyone with less than 6 months in a new craft, role, or entity, regardless of total experience. A 20-year operator new to our work is an SSE for our purposes: they know the machine, they do not yet know us. New employees are statistically at their highest risk of injury in their first months, and this chapter exists because of it.

21.2 The Orientation Gate

No SSE performs field work until orientation is complete: the condensed field handbook delivered and acknowledged, the 7 Rules signed for, entity and client credentials verified per the pre-mobilization requirements, and the training matrix items for the role completed. Orientation is a gate, never a formality, and dispatch does not assign an employee whose gate is open.

21.3 Mentoring and Identification

- Every SSE is assigned a mentor: an experienced crew member designated by the foreman, responsible for pairing with the SSE on tasks, checking understanding at the tailboard, and speaking up on their behalf.
- SSEs are visually identifiable on site per the entity standard (hard hat marking or equivalent) so every crew knows who is new. The marking is a signal for extra eyes, never a target; hazing of new employees is a conduct violation handled under the Handbook.
- Crew composition respects experience: supervisors plan crews so SSEs are distributed, not concentrated, and client SSE ratio limits are honored where they apply.

21.4 Graduation

SSE status ends when the time threshold passes and the foreman and Corporate Safety confirm the training matrix for the role is complete and performance in the field supports it. Concerns extend the mentoring period; a calendar date alone does not end it.

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CHAPTER 22. SUBCONTRACTOR SAFETY MANAGEMENT

Applied at Hays Ranches to farm labor contractors and custom operators per the CORE-AG variant: licensed FLC verification is part of prequalification, an executed agreement precedes work, and pesticide application contractors additionally show DPR licensing. Commercial terms are governed by the agreement; this chapter governs safety on Ranch property.

22.1 Prequalification and the Contract Gate

- Subcontractors are prequalified before award on safety criteria: EMR, OSHA history, program adequacy, and client system requirements (ISNetworld or equivalent) where the contract demands them.
- No subcontractor mobilizes without an executed subcontract, including its safety exhibits and insurance. The scheduling PM bears responsibility for this gate. Urgent situations escalate to the VP or CEO with Contracts copied; escalation is a path to fast execution, never a bypass of the requirement.

22.2 Flow-Down and Orientation

- The subcontract flows down this manual's site requirements: the 7 Rules, stop work authority, PPE minimums, pre-task planning, incident reporting timelines, and client site rules. The stricter rule governs on our sites.
- Every subcontractor employee receives our site orientation before starting work: site hazards, emergency plan, the 7 Rules, reporting, and the site-specific requirements. Orientation is documented, and an unoriented worker does not work.
- Subcontractors performing high-hazard work (excavation, energized work, hoisting, confined space, work over traffic or track) submit their task plans for review before the work, and their competent and qualified persons are identified by name.

22.3 Oversight, Stop Work, and Incidents

- Our superintendent's stop work authority extends to every subcontractor on the site, and subcontractor personnel hold the same authority over conditions that endanger them. A stopped subcontractor operation restarts under Chapter 6.
- Subcontractors report every injury, near miss, utility contact, and damage event on our sites to our superintendent the same shift, and participate in our investigation under Chapter 8 in addition to their own.
- Repeated or serious subcontractor safety violations are addressed through the subcontract's remedies up to removal from the site, and are recorded in the subcontractor's performance file for future prequalification. As a controlling employer, the Company exercises reasonable care to detect and correct hazardous conditions created by any employer on its sites.

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CHAPTER 23. TRAINING AND ORIENTATION

The role-based training matrix is maintained alongside this chapter and loads per entity.

23.1 The System

Training here is a system with a gate, a matrix, and a record, not a stack of certificates. The gate is orientation: nobody works in the field without it. The matrix defines what every role must hold, initially and on refresh. The record proves it, per Chapter 9, and pre-mobilization verification checks it before a crew ships. Pre-mobilization qualification (ISNetworld, RWP and eRailSafe, client credentials) and field orientation are distinct steps: the first proves the gate is satisfied, the second delivers the site and the life-critical subset to the person standing on it.

23.2 Orientation

- Every new hire, rehire, and inter-entity transfer completes entity orientation before field assignment: this manual's field layer (the condensed handbook), the 7 Rules with signed acknowledgment, the Employee Safety Acknowledgment, stop work authority, reporting duties, PPE issue, and the IIPP basics of Chapter 3.
- Orientation is delivered in a language and manner the employee understands, Spanish included where crews require it, with comprehension checked, not assumed.

23.3 The Training Matrix

The matrix maps every role to its required training: regulatory (per this manual and its work sections), certification (operator cards, ATSSA for flagging work, competent person designations, first aid/CPR coverage), client-required (RWP, eRailSafe, client orientations), and refreshers with their cadences. Corporate Safety owns the matrix, tracks expirations, and flags lapses to dispatch and supervisors before they become field problems. An expired requirement means no assignment to the affected work until it is current.

23.4 Delivery and Verification

- Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time, for every employee, always.
- Operating credentials require demonstration, not just attendance: operator cards and competent person designations are issued on evaluated performance per their programs.
- Toolbox talks (weekly minimum) and tailboards (daily) are the field refreshers that keep the formal training alive; both are documented with topic and attendance.
- Training effectiveness is checked in the field: inspections and investigations that find a knowledge gap trigger retraining and a matrix review, per the version control process.

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CHAPTER 24. RETURN TO WORK

The Return to Work Program document governs in full; this chapter states the entity's commitment and the field interface.

24.1 Philosophy

An injured employee is still our employee. The Company's Return to Work Program exists to keep people connected to work, income, and crew while they recover: transitional and modified duty is offered wherever medically appropriate work exists, matched to written restrictions, at no loss of dignity. Staying at work and returning early to real, useful, restriction-compliant tasks produces better medical outcomes than sitting at home, and the Company plans modified assignments the way it plans any other work.

24.2 How It Runs

- Medical care and claims initiation follow Chapter 14 and the claims protocol; the designated clinic is provided the essential functions of the job so restrictions come back specific, not generic.
- HR and Corporate Safety coordinate every restriction with the supervisor. A modified assignment honors the restrictions exactly: a supervisor never asks, hints, or allows an employee to work outside written restrictions, and an employee reports any task that conflicts with theirs. Violations of restrictions are treated as the safety issue they are.
- Modified duty is reviewed at every medical re-evaluation until full release. Communication with the recovering employee is regular and goes through HR and the supervisor; nobody disappears into a claim.
- Filing a claim or accepting modified duty is never retaliated against, period.

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CHAPTER 25. DRIVING AND FLEET SAFETY

The Fleet Management Program, the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix, and field procedures P-1 through P-3 are the single source of truth for fleet, DOT, and driver qualification matters; this chapter is the safety manual's interface to them.

25.1 The Rules Every Driver Follows

Rule 6 of the 7 Rules governs every Company vehicle and every piece of mobile equipment: seatbelts on, spotter when backing, phone down. In addition:

- Every occupant belted before the vehicle moves. No exceptions, no short trips.
- No handheld phone use in motion; hands-free minimized and never in complex driving. A call, text, or navigation entry can wait for a stopped, parked vehicle.
- Backing gets a spotter where one is available, and a walk-around when alone. Pull-through and first-move-forward parking are standard practice.
- Speed and following distance matched to conditions, loads secured per the applicable module before the vehicle moves, and impaired or dangerously fatigued driving prohibited under Chapter 15.
- Journey management for long hauls and remote work: route, fuel, rest, and check-in planned before departure per the fleet procedures.

25.2 Authority and Qualification

The Fleet Manager is the authority for vehicle assignment, maintenance, DOT compliance, telematics, and driver qualification under the Fleet Management Program. Only authorized, qualified drivers operate Company vehicles; CDL, medical card, and DOT requirements are tracked under that program, and hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers. Vehicle defects are reported per the fleet inspection procedures, and a vehicle with a safety defect does not roll.

25.3 Events

Every vehicle event (collision, citation, telematics escalation, damage) is reported the same shift under Chapter 8 and handled under the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix. Where an event is also a 7 Rules violation, Chapter 5.9 applies: one event, one committee, one outcome.

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APPENDIX A. ENTITY INFORMATION AND DESIGNATED PERSONS

HAYS RANCHES

A1. Entity Identity

Field	Entry
Legal name	Hays Ranches LLC
Contractor license(s)	Not applicable
States of operation	California

A2. Named Persons

Role	Name	Function
Chief Executive Officer	Kirby Hays	Review Committee
Vice President	Karun Mani	Review Committee
Corporate Safety Officer / IIPP Administrator	Sergio Robles	Review Committee; program administration
HR Manager	Desiree Tapia	Review Committee; discipline execution
Field Operations	Jerry Neuman	Advisory to Committee on field impact
Fleet Manager	Derek Alonso	Vehicle, DOT, and driver qualification authority

Entity Role	Name
Ranch Manager	Hal Hays

Designated competent persons by discipline, first aid/CPR roster, and operator card holders are maintained in the training matrix by Corporate Safety. To confirm any designation, contact Corporate Safety.

A3. Facilities

Facility	Address
Alturas ranch	32139 HWY 299, Alturas, CA 96101. Responder direction sheet with gate and GPS posted per AG-02.
Red Bluff ranch	10185 Briggs Road, Red Bluff, CA 96080. Responder direction sheet with gate and GPS posted per AG-02.

A4. Chapter Inserts and Switches

Insert	Setting
Ch 5.10 CBA insert	OFF
Ch 22 (adapted)	ON as adapted: farm labor contractors and custom operators per CORE-AG
Pesticide program	Separate DPR Worker Protection compliance program; interface per AG-02
Chapter 12	Replaced by AG-03

A5. Entity PPE Table (additions to the Chapter 11 minimum)

Work	Additional PPE
Equipment operation	Per AG-01: hearing protection, task gloves
Field work	Sun protection, task gloves, chaps/face protection for cutting and brush work per AG-02
Night work	Class 2 hi-vis per AG-03

A6. Work Sections in This Manual

A7. Medical and Posting Information

Posting Item	Entry
Designated occupational clinic(s)	Alturas: Modoc Medical Center, 1111 N Nagle St, Alturas, CA 96101. Red Bluff: Lassen Medical Clinic (Red Oaks Medical Group), 2450 Sister Mary Columba Dr, Red Bluff, CA 96080
Nearest emergency room (per facility)	Alturas: Modoc Medical Center ER, 228 W McDowell Ave, Alturas, CA 96101. Red Bluff: Dignity Health St. Elizabeth Community Hospital, 2550 Sister Mary Columba Dr, Red Bluff, CA 96080
Cal/OSHA / ADOSH reporting contact	Corporate Safety Officer: Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912
Jobsite posting kit	Per the Company portable posting kit program, entity-specific

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APPENDIX B. VARIANT RECORD

HAYS RANCHES

AGRICULTURAL APPLICATION NOTES

the chapters of this manual are used as written except as treated below, with the agricultural work sections inserted. Not cloned construction content: what does not apply to a working ranch does not appear in its manual.

How the Variant Works

Hays Ranches is a California agricultural operation under Cal/OSHA jurisdiction. The core program (IIPP, enforcement, stop work, pre-task planning, incident reporting, recordkeeping, hazcom, PPE, heat, emergency action, first aid) is the same system every Hays Group company runs, applied to ranch work. The construction-specific chapters and modules stay out; the agricultural chapters AG-01 through AG-03 come in. This manual is issued by and speaks only for Hays Ranches.

Chapter-by-Chapter Treatment

Chapter	Agricultural Variant Treatment
1 through 3	Unchanged. IIPP anchored to T8 3203, which applies to agricultural employers the same as everyone else.
4. Code of Safe Practices	Covers equipment, field work, heat, and shop content only.
5 through 9	Unchanged. One standard, one ladder, one committee, one log, same reporting clocks including the Cal/OSHA 8-hour serious injury report.
10. Hazard Communication	Unchanged for shop and general chemicals (fuels, oils, solvents, fertilizers as chemicals). Pesticide handling, application, and re-entry are governed by the separate Pesticide Worker Protection compliance program under DPR (Title 3) and the licensed applicator requirements; this manual does not substitute for it.
11. PPE	Unchanged, with the Ranches PPE table in the skin (sun protection, task gloves, hearing protection around equipment, chaps and face protection for cutting and brush work). Pesticide PPE per the DPR program.
12. Heat Illness	Replaced by AG-03, which carries the full 3395 program plus the agricultural high-heat additions and night work provisions.
13 through 17	Unchanged. Emergency action covers remote field locations per AG-02; first aid staffing recognizes lone and remote work.
18. Tools / 19. Ladders	Retained: ranch work uses both. Orchard and field ladder use follows Chapter 19 plus the agricultural work sections.

20. Workplace Violence	Unchanged. LC 6401.9 applies to the Ranches; the violent incident log and annual training are statutory.
21. Short Service Employees	Unchanged, and applied to seasonal labor: every seasonal hire is an SSE with the full orientation gate, every season.
22. Subcontractor Management	Adapted scope: applies to farm labor contractors and custom operators (harvest, spray, hauling). Licensed FLC verification is part of prequalification, an executed agreement precedes work, and pesticide application contractors additionally show DPR licensing. Same orientation, stop work, and reporting rules on Ranch property.
23 through 25	Unchanged. Training matrix carries the AG-01 equipment training requirements; driving chapter covers ranch trucks and public road travel of equipment per AG-01.
Work modules	AG-01 (tractors and agricultural equipment), AG-02 (field work and sanitation), AG-03 (agricultural heat and night work), plus shop safety. Construction modules do not insert.

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PART II. WORK MODULES

MODULE AG-01. TRACTORS AND AGRICULTURAL EQUIPMENT

Applies to tractors, implements, ATVs/UTVs, loaders, and all self-propelled and towed agricultural equipment. Shop repair work follows the shop safety module.

1. Operators

Only trained, authorized operators run equipment, and the training is documented per T8 3441 and the training matrix: for each machine type, at hire, at new assignment, and refreshed at least annually. Training covers the manufacturer's operating instructions, the specific hazards of the attachment in use, and the rules in this module. No operator card or documented equivalent, no seat time. Riders are prohibited on any equipment not built with a passenger seat: no fender riders, no bucket rides, no trailer riding except on equipment designed for it.

2. ROPS and Seatbelts

Rollovers are the leading killer in agriculture. Every tractor is equipped with a rollover protective structure, and the seatbelt is worn whenever the ROPS is up. A foldable ROPS is down only where overhead clearance genuinely requires it (orchard canopy), is returned upright as soon as the low work ends, and the seatbelt comes off while the ROPS is down: belted to a tractor without protection is the worst of both. Operating with the ROPS removed is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.

3. PTO and Implements

- PTO master shields and driveline guards stay on and intact. A missing or damaged shield takes the machine out of service until replaced. Reaching over, stepping across, or working near an engaged PTO is prohibited; loose clothing, drawstrings, and long hair are secured around rotating drivelines.
- Before leaving the seat: PTO disengaged, implement lowered to the ground or blocked, engine off for any work on the implement, key controlled, and stored energy released. Hydraulically raised implements are never trusted on hydraulics alone; mechanical blocking before anyone goes under.
- Hitching uses the drawbar and proper pins; one person hitches while the operator's hands are off the controls. Nobody stands between tractor and implement while the tractor is moving. Towed loads are matched to the tractor's capacity and braking.
- Unplugging and clearing jams (balers, mowers, augers, harvest equipment) happens with the machine off, energy released, and verified stopped. A machine that is only disengaged is not off.

4. Operation

- Slopes, ditches, and banks are driven with the load and center of gravity in mind: up and down rather than across where grade allows, speed matched to terrain, loaded buckets carried low, and known hazard areas (soft ground, ditch edges, irrigation cuts) identified at the tailboard.
- People and equipment separate: workers on foot stay out of operating areas, operators confirm the area is clear before moving or raising, and backing gets a look, a horn, or a spotter per conditions. Children and unauthorized persons are never in work areas, ever.
- Public road travel: SMV emblem, lighting and flashers per vehicle code, escorts or route planning for wide loads, and the same seatbelt and phone rules as Chapter 25.
- Refueling engine-off, no smoking, and hot work away from fuel and dry vegetation; equipment exhaust and field conditions make fire prevention part of daily operation, with an extinguisher on each tractor and crew truck.

5. Inspection and Maintenance

Operators complete the daily equipment checklist before use: brakes, steering, hydraulics, shields and guards, ROPS and belt, tires, lights, and leaks. Defects are reported per the shop program, and a machine with a safety defect does not run. Field repairs follow the same energy control rules as the shop: off, blocked, released, verified.

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MODULE AG-02. FIELD WORK AND SANITATION

Field sanitation per T8 3457. Pesticide handling, application, and re-entry intervals are governed by the separate DPR Worker Protection compliance program.

1. Field Sanitation

- Toilet and handwashing facilities are provided for hand-labor field work: at least one toilet and handwashing facility per 20 employees of each sex, within a quarter mile of the work (or the nearest practicable point of vehicle access), kept clean, stocked, and serviced.
- Potable drinking water per Chapter 12 and AG-03: fresh, suitably cool, one quart per hour, with single-use cups or fountains, never a common cup.
- Reasonable use is the rule: employees use facilities as needed, and the schedule accommodates it. Handwashing before eating and after facility use is basic exposure control.

2. Working in the Field

- Every field crew's tailboard covers the same daily items as any Hays Group crew: the task, the hazards (equipment traffic, terrain, heat, wildlife, tools), the controls, and the emergency plan for that field, including how responders find it: ranch name, gate, road, and GPS coordinates where addresses fail.
- Lone and remote work uses a check-in system: schedule, method, and who calls when a check is missed. Nobody works a remote field unaccounted for.
- Hand tools and cutting work follow Chapter 18 and the PPE table; snake and insect awareness, uneven terrain, and irrigation infrastructure (open ditches, standpipes, pump electrical) are briefed hazards, and pump and irrigation electrical work is qualified-person work only.
- Vehicles and equipment moving among workers on foot follow AG-01 separation rules; harvest operations plan the interface between hand crews, equipment, and haul trucks before the day starts.

3. Pesticides Interface

This manual governs general field safety. Pesticide storage, mixing, application, notification, re-entry intervals, application-specific PPE, and handler training are governed by the DPR Worker Protection compliance program and the licensed applicator's requirements. Field crews are informed of treated areas and re-entry status before assignment, posted areas are respected without exception, and any suspected exposure is treated as a medical event under Chapter 14 and reported under Chapter 8 the same shift.

Hays Ranches LLC

EARTHMOVING AND HEAVY EQUIPMENT

Governs excavators, loaders, dozers, graders, compactors, and skid steers in all operations.

1. Scope and Principle

This module governs mobile earthmoving equipment. Two things kill around this iron: unqualified hands on the controls, and people on foot inside the machine's working envelope. Both are controlled by verification and position, not by trust.

Operating equipment without verified qualification, and assigning an operator without verifying qualification, are Chapter 5 violations for the operator and the assigning supervisor alike.

2. Operator Qualification and Assignment

- Every operator holds a current, documented qualification for the specific class of equipment before the seat time starts. The supervisor verifies and documents the qualification in the pre-task plan before assignment; schedule pressure, customer pressure, and operational need never override this.
- Trainees operate only under a designated qualified trainer, in controlled conditions, documented as training time.
- Qualification records are tracked centrally; an expired or unverifiable qualification comes off the equipment schedule until resolved.

3. Pre-Operation and Equipment Condition

- Documented pre-shift inspection per the manufacturer: controls, brakes, alarms, cameras and mirrors, glass, fire extinguisher, and seatbelt. Defects are reported per the Equipment Damage Standard; safety-critical defects park the machine.
- Backup alarms and cameras are life-safety devices: a machine with a dead alarm does not work around people on foot, period.
- Mounting and dismounting uses three points of contact, facing the machine, never jumping and never with hands full.

4. The Working Envelope

- The swing radius and travel path of every machine is a controlled zone: nobody on foot inside it without positive communication with the operator. Eye contact and acknowledgment before approach, every time, no matter how many years the two people have worked together.

- Ground personnel and operators own the rule jointly: the operator shuts down or holds when someone must enter the envelope; the person on foot never assumes they were seen.
- Spotters are used when backing where vision is limited (Rule 6), around utilities per HC-02, and near edges per HC-01. Spotter positioning keeps an escape path and never puts the spotter between the machine and a fixed object.
- Loads travel low; buckets and blades never pass over people, cabs, or occupied vehicles; and nobody rides buckets, hitches, or steps.
- Slopes, edges, and benches are worked per the competent person's direction and the machine's limits; undercutting the bench you sit on has buried machines and operators together.

5. Shutdown and Securing

- Attachments grounded, parking brake set, controls neutralized, and key controlled at every dismount; a running machine is never left unattended.
- Equipment parked for the day is grounded, secured against movement and vandal start, and positioned clear of traffic and drainage.

6. Training and Verification

- Qualification per equipment class with practical evaluation; refresher after incidents, damage events, or observed deficiencies per the Equipment Damage Standard.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: qualifications documented in the pre-task plan, envelope discipline, alarms functional, seatbelts on.

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MODULE VB-08. WELDING, CUTTING AND HOT WORK

Governs arc welding, torch cutting, brazing, grinding with spark production near combustibles, and the hot work permit system. Replaces the legacy Electric Welding and Gas Systems chapters. Cylinders per SS-04.

1. The Permit

- Hot work outside a designated hot work area requires a hot work permit: combustibles within 35 feet removed, protected, or shielded; floor and wall openings covered; a charged extinguisher at the work; and a trained fire watch during the work and for at least 30 minutes after the last spark, longer where the permit says so.
- Hot work does not happen on containers, tanks, or piping that held flammables until they are cleaned, tested, and cleared under a specific plan. Not ever on a hunch.

2. The Work

- Welders and helpers: shade-rated eye and face protection, FR clothing free of oil, dry gloves, and screens protecting adjacent workers and the public from arc flash. Grinding sparks count as hot work near combustibles.
- Ventilation matched to the work: mechanical ventilation or IH-02 respiratory protection for enclosed spaces, coated or galvanized metals, stainless, and any work producing visible fume the welder breathes. Welding on coated material triggers a VB-07 check first.
- Electrical: machines grounded, leads inspected and free of splices near the holder, electrodes removed when unattended, and machines off for lead work.
- Torch work: flashback arrestors, regulators inspected, lines purged and torch lit per sequence with a striker, never a lighter. Cylinder handling, securing, and separation per SS-04.

3. Where

- Hot work in confined spaces runs under EL-04 with continuous monitoring and cylinders staged outside the space. Hot work near fueling, vegetation, or during fire weather follows Chapter 13, and red flag conditions can suspend field hot work entirely.

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MODULE IH-01. NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION

The hearing conservation program. Anchored to 29 CFR 1926.52/1910.95 and T8 CCR 5095 series. Replaces the legacy Noise Exposure Program chapters.

1. The Standard

- At or above an 8-hour average of 85 dBA, the hearing conservation program applies: protection provided, training delivered, and audiometric testing offered per the standard. A working test: if you must raise your voice to be understood at arm's length, protection goes in.
- Posted high-noise areas and designated high-noise equipment (impact tools, milling, pile driving, vacuum blowers, grinding, saws, shop air tools) require protection every time, full stop.
- Dual protection (plugs plus muffs) for the loudest operations: impact pile driving, extended jackhammer work, and any operation so designated by Corporate Safety.

2. Program Elements

- Protection is provided at no cost in at least two forms; fit and use are taught, not assumed, and protectors are matched to the exposure so speech and alarms remain audible.
- Audiometric testing: baseline within the standard's window for covered employees and annual tests thereafter, coordinated confidentially by HR; standard threshold shifts trigger refit, retraining, and follow-up per the standard.
- Buy quiet and keep quiet: equipment purchases consider noise, mufflers and enclosures are maintained, and a missing muffler is an equipment defect, not a personality trait.
- Training annually for covered employees: effects of noise, purpose and use of protectors, and the audiometric program. Documented per Chapter 9.

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Hays Ranches LLC

MODULE TR-01. DOT / FMCSA FLEET COMPLIANCE POINTER

Pointer module: the Fleet Management Program is the single source of truth for all DOT and FMCSA matters. This module tells every entity where those obligations live and who owns them; it duplicates nothing.

1. What Lives in the Fleet Program

- Driver qualification files, CDL and medical certificate tracking, and the driver roster: owned by the Fleet Manager.
- Hours of service, ELD administration, and exemption determinations.
- Vehicle inspection program: pre-trip and post-trip DVIR requirements, periodic inspections, and out-of-service criteria. A written-up safety defect parks the vehicle per Chapter 25.
- DOT drug and alcohol program under 49 CFR Part 382, administered through the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including post-accident testing decision criteria.
- CSA scores, roadside inspection results, and DataQ challenges.

2. What This Manual Adds

- The safety consequence layer: Rule 6, Chapter 25 driving rules, Chapter 15 fitness and fatigue, and the Chapter 5.9 one-event-one-committee rule for events that are both DOT matters and safety violations.
- Same-shift reporting of every roadside inspection, citation, collision, and out-of-service order to the Fleet Manager and Corporate Safety per Chapter 8.

3. Who Is Covered

- Every driver of a CMV as defined by the regulations, at every entity that operates one, per the Fleet Program's applicability determinations. Whether a vehicle or driver is DOT-covered is the Fleet Manager's call, made in writing, not a foreman's guess.

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MODULE TR-02. DUMP, TRANSFER AND WATER TRUCK OPERATIONS

Governs end dumps, transfers, side dumps, and water trucks in yard, highway, and jobsite service. DOT matters per TR-01; securement per TR-03.

1. The Raised Bed Rule

A raised bed under a power line is this industry's most repeated fatal mistake. The bed travels down. No truck moves with the bed raised beyond the crawl needed to spread, and every dump site is checked overhead before the bed goes up: power lines, structures, trees. The EL-01 clearances apply to the fully raised bed, and a site that cannot provide them is dumped somewhere else.

2. Dumping

- Dump on firm, level ground: cross-slope tipping and soft-edge rollbacks roll trucks. Fill edges are treated per HC-05 with berms or a spotter holding trucks back from the edge; the spotter stands where the driver sees them, never behind the truck.
- Stuck gates are cleared with the bed down and energy controlled, never by raising higher and rocking; a load hung in the bed is a spotter-cleared, bed-down problem.
- Transfers: box transfer on level ground per the manufacturer's sequence, pins verified, and nobody between truck and trailer during the transfer.

3. Water Trucks

- Spray runs are planned: no spraying that fogs windshields of live traffic or glazes compacted haul roads in freezing weather; night spraying with lighting per the site plan.
- Tank dynamics are real: partial loads surge, and speed on grades and corners is set for a moving load. Filling from hydrants or standpipes follows the client rules and backflow requirements.

4. Every Shift

- Walk-around plus DVIR per TR-01: tailgate locks, hoist, hydraulics, tires, lights, backup alarm. Backing per Rule 6: spotter when available, walk-around when alone. In-cab phones down; tarping done from the ground or with fall protection per TR-03.

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MODULE TR-03. LOAD SECUREMENT AND HEAVY HAUL

Governs securement of equipment and materials and lowbed/heavy haul operations. FMCSA securement standards govern; this module is the field procedure.

1. Securement Standard

- Every load is secured to the FMCSA standard: tiedowns with aggregate working load limit of at least half the cargo weight, minimum tiedown counts by length and article, and chains, binders, and straps that are rated, marked, and undamaged. Damaged securement gear is destroyed, not downgraded.
- Heavy equipment is a four-point minimum: independent chains at designated tie-down points, attachments (buckets, blades, booms) lowered and secured separately, and accessory equipment secured as its own article.
- The driver owns the check: securement inspected before departure, within the first miles, and at duty-status and interval checks per the regulation. Re-tension is expected, not exceptional.

2. Loading and Unloading

- Loading follows the equipment operator and the ramp plan: lowbed on level ground, ramps set and pinned for the machine's track width, a clear line of travel, and nobody beside the machine on the ramps or in the tip-over shadow. The truck driver is out of the cab and clear during loading.
- Machine operators load per HC-05 qualification; centering and chock/cribbing per the trailer's requirements before the first chain goes on.
- Tarping and trailer access: from the ground with poles and throw lines where possible; climbing on loads only where designed access exists, per the fall prevention practices in the HTI skin.

3. Heavy Haul

- Overweight and overdimension moves run on permit terms exactly: route survey done, heights verified against the surveyed route (bridges and lines measured, not recalled), escorts arranged per the permit, and travel windows respected.
- Route deviations require a new determination, not driver judgment; a closed route ends the move until dispatch and the permit are squared.

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Hays Ranches LLC

HAZARDOUS MATERIALS, WASTE AND SPILL RESPONSE

Governs chemical storage, handling, waste streams, and spill response in shops, yards, and the field.

1. Scope

This module governs hazardous materials from arrival to disposal: fuels, oils, coolants, solvents, treatment chemicals, batteries, and the wastes the work generates. Hazard communication (labels, SDS, training) is this manual chapter; this module is the physical handling.

2. Storage and Handling

- Flammables live in rated cabinets or approved storage areas, quantities within limits, away from ignition and exits; incompatibles (acids and bases, oxidizers and fuels) are separated by distance or containment.
- Every container is labeled; transfer containers get workplace labels the moment product goes in. An unlabeled jug gets treated as unknown and disposed properly, not sniffed and guessed.
- Bulk fuel and lube storage has secondary containment sized per the rules, inspected on the facility schedule, with fill and dispense procedures that keep hoses attended and drips caught.
- Field fueling follows the bonding, attended-nozzle, and no-ignition rules everywhere the truck goes; fuel and chemical transport in vehicles follows the quantity and securement rules of the Fleet Management Program.

3. Waste Streams

- Used oil, coolant, solvents, filters, absorbents, batteries, and aerosols each go into their designated, labeled accumulation containers; nothing is mixed, and nothing goes into the trash, the ground, or a drain.
- Accumulation areas are inspected on the facility schedule, containers closed except when adding, and pickups by licensed vendors documented with manifests retained.
- Hydrovac slurry, treatment chemical waste, and contaminated soil follow the disposal requirements in their modules with manifests to the project file.

4. Spill Response

- Spill kits are staged at fixed stations in shops and yards and on every service and hydrovac truck, stocked for the products carried, and checked on the inspection cycle.
- Small spills within the crew's training are stopped at the source, contained ahead of drains and soil, absorbed, and cleaned, with waste disposed as hazardous; drains are protected first because a spill that reaches water changes jurisdiction.

- Spills beyond the crew's training or products, or any spill reaching soil, water, or a drain, escalate immediately: isolate the area, notify the supervisor and Corporate Safety, and make the agency notifications the law requires within their time limits. Reportable quantities and numbers are posted with the spill kits.
- Every spill, including recovered ones, is reported the same shift and logged per Chapter 8.

5. Training and Verification

- Handling and spill response training for shop, fueling, hydrovac, and treatment crews; awareness for everyone per the hazcom chapter.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: labeling, containment condition, kit stocking, manifest files current.

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MODULE SS-03. FORKLIFTS AND INDUSTRIAL TRUCKS

Governs forklifts, telehandlers, and powered industrial trucks in yards, shops, and jobsites. Anchored to 29 CFR 1910.178 and T8 CCR 3650 series. Replaces the legacy Industrial Trucks chapters.

1. Operators

- Certified operators only: training and evaluation per the standard for the specific truck type, re-evaluation at least every three years and after any incident or observed deficiency. Certification is tracked in the training matrix. Telehandlers with suspended loads or work platforms invoke VB-03/VB-04 requirements respectively.

2. Operating Rules

- Seatbelt on, every movement. In a tip-over: stay in the seat, brace, lean away from the fall. Jumping kills forklift operators.
- Load within the capacity plate for the attachment in use, forks low when traveling, load upgrade on ramps, and speed matched to surface, load, and visibility. Travel in reverse when the load blocks forward view.
- Pedestrian separation is the fatal-risk control: horn at corners and doorways, eye contact before proximity, no one under raised forks ever, and no riders. People are elevated only on a manufacturer-approved platform, secured, with controls attended.
- Parking: forks down, controls neutral, brake set, key controlled; on any grade, wheels chocked.

3. Trucks and Fuel

- Daily pre-use checklist per the shop program; a truck with defective brakes, steering, hydraulics, or horn is tagged out per SS-01. LP cylinder changes and charging-station rules per SS-04 and the shop module; charging areas ventilated and ignition-controlled.

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